

Looking for work outside

Unit 3

Interviews



Looking for work outside: interviews

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Overview

This is a listening and speaking lesson, based on a job interview recording, in which an ex offender answers questions about his / her time in prison. It provides differentiated listening comprehension activities and speaking practice for handling job interviews. The lesson is comprised of a mix of whole class and small group or pair work to enable all learners to work on the same content at their own level. Learners at all levels should be encouraged to contribute to the whole class feedback after to build confidence in their speaking skills.

Level : ESOL Entry 1-3; National 2- 4, CEFR A1-B1

Time: 90 minutes

Aims

For all learners:

- Provide practice at listening to and understanding typical interview questions
- To give a model of language to use when giving answers to interview questions.
- Practise having a job interview

Objectives

All learners will be able to:

- Understand gist and detail in a job interview for a cleaning job
- Understand and respond appropriately to specific job interview questions (appropriate to level)
- Choose / use correct question forms and role play an interview between an employer and an ex-offender.

Entry 2 learners will be able to:

- Ask and answer interview questions about past work and training, using the past simple

Entry 3 learners will also be able to:

- Use the present perfect tense to ask and answer questions about work experience.

Preparation**You will need:**

- **Resource 1**- the image of a job interview - for display on IWB/ OHP
- **Resource 2** image cards for matching activity, one per pair for lower levels and one each for higher.
- **Resource 3a -c** one copy at the appropriate level, for each learner
- **Resource 4** job images and prompts, cut up enough for groups of three or four
- **Resource 5 a – c** preparing for an interview, one copy per learner
- **Resource 6** dialogue, print and cut up—one set for each pair
- **Audio TP_Workoutside_U3_interview_men** or **TP_Workoutside_U3_interview_women** and a device to play them
- Information on the certificated training courses available in your prison.

Consider:

- How to seat learners so that they can work with others at a similar level
- Using a peer mentor to provide support with speaking activities while you work with lower-level learners.

Interviews

Warmer- 5 minutes

Discussion – help with getting a job

- Display **resource 1** (women or men) and elicit from the class what the situation is. Ask them who the people are, and what they are doing. Ask how they feel about job interviews.
- Ask what courses you can do in prison to train you for work outside. Can they get certificates? Do they know what they are called e. g. BICS for cleaning.

Activity 1: pre-listening vocabulary (5 minutes)

- Sit learners in pairs or small groups according to their levels.
- Hand out or display **resource 2** and focus learners' attention on the words at the top of the page.
- Drill the pronunciation of the words. If pronunciation is difficult, demonstrate the stress by underlining the stressed syllable, **and using gestures**.
- Point out the 'k' sound in 'chemicals' , the 'sh' sound in machine and the 's' in certificate.
- Give higher-level learners a copy each if you haven't already and ask them to write the letter by the word in the box by the corresponding image. Support lower-level learners to do the activity in pairs or threes.

Differentiation: elicit other words which have the 'k' , 'sh' and 's' sounds from stronger learners and write them on the board, to demonstrate different spellings of the same sounds.

Pre-entry learners could focus on recognising the letters and sounds of **clean**, **chemicals**, **certificate**, **floor**.

Activity 2: Listening for gist (10 minutes)

- Tell learners they are going to listen to two people talking. Ask what they think it will be about – show them resource 1 as a prompt.
- Focus learners' attention on **resource 2**. Make sure they understand the question. Tell them to listen, they don't need to write anything.
- Play the first 40 seconds of the audio for either a male or female group .
- Ask gist questions to check understanding..

Who are the two people talking? *Lee and an interviewer.*

What are they talking about? *A cleaning job / Lee wants to be a cleaner*

What kind of a conversation is this? *An interview.*

Nominate more confident learners to answer questions about the text before moving on to lower-level learners.

- Check that lower-level learners have understood what it is about – repeat the questions, adding more where necessary e. g. *What is an interview? What is the job? Does Lee want the job?*

Activity 3: Listening for detail (15 minutes)

- Tell learners that they are now going to listen for detail. Hand out the appropriate level of **resource 3a-c** to each group. They will listen again and decide if they are true or false. They should tick the true sentences.
- Play the first part of the recording and elicit the answer to the first question. Demonstrate how to mark the answer, by putting a tick on the board.
- Now proceed to play the rest of the recording.

Learning check: Nominate learners to feed back. Ask Entry 3 learners for corrections to the false statements.

- Focus learners' attention on the second task.
- Now play the recording again for the learners to answer the questions.
- Do the same for the last task.
- Give each pair of higher level learners the transcript of the interview to check and correct their answers together while you support the lower-level learners to check theirs.

Differentiation: Pause the recording to allow learners time to write.

Learning check

Play the recording, pausing at each answer and asking individual learners to give answers.

Activity 4: (10 minutes) Preparing for interview

- Display images from **resource 4** of the 4 jobs (recycling, filing, driver, using a computer / talking on phone). Ask the whole class : *who needs a drivers' licence? Who can use a computer? Who works outside?*
- Organise learners into mixed group abilities. Give each small group a set of **resource 4** cards. Ask learners to use the cards to discuss and sort which skills you need for each job.
- Ask which of these skills you can learn in prison.
- Now tell them to use the question prompt cards to make questions for the rest of the skills. Demonstrate by reading a question stem and eliciting a matching end.

- They then take it in turns to ask their partner the questions.
- Monitor and support pairs during the activity.

Learning check

- Nominate individual learners to tell you the questions they have made.

Activity 5 (15 minutes)

- Arrange learners in ability groups and give them each a copy of **resource 5 a - c**, at their level.
- Ask them to complete the first task and compare their answers with a partner.
- Ask individual learners for answers- lower-level learners have the same gaps to complete, whereas those at E3 / N4 will have used their own ideas.
- Drill the questions and answers for clear intonation and pronunciation and practise around the class in open pairs, if you have a lot of low level learners.
- Finally, focus their attention on the speech bubbles and tell them to match the questions with the short answers.
- Direct them to practise in pairs. Encourage the learners to memorise the questions and short answers by covering the answers.
- Give them a time limit of 5 minutes to practise, so that you can sit with learners at E2 / N3 and above to facilitate the grammar tasks on the resource.

Differentiation

- Encourage Entry 2 and 3 (N3/4) learners to work together. Focus their attention on the irregular verbs in the table on **resource 5c**. Tell them to read the examples and elicit the correct answer (past simple). They should work in pairs to complete the verb table.
- Entry 3 learners have a grammar focus on the present perfect tense, but can work together with Entry 2 learners to compare the past simple irregular verb forms.
- When they have completed the verb table, check their answers.
- Direct them to complete the gap fill exercises in pairs.

Learning check

- Get the attention of the whole class, for feedback on interview questions and answers. Ask all the groups to feed back their interview questions and answers.
- You could do some peer correction on the board, if there are a lot of mistakes with past simple verbs

Activity 6- interview role-play (30 minutes)

- Put the learners into pairs, according to level.
- Give each pair **resource 6** - a cut up dialogue between an employer and an ex-offender.
- They should reorder the dialogue. Ask the first pair to complete to read it out while the others check.
- Drill the dialogue for clear intonation and pronunciation, then direct learners to practise in pairs, taking it in turns to read the interviewer and interviewee roles.
- If you have a classroom supporter, or a very confident learner, act out the scenario together with you as the interviewee. Either demonstrate appropriate body language and smiling, having a firm handshake and so on, or play a poor interviewee and demonstrate inappropriate behaviour – no smiling, eyes down looking unconfident or shifty, limp handshake.
- Ask learners if they thought that you got the job. Why not? What should you do differently?
- Repeat as a confident candidate but do one thing badly. Ask learners '*what did I do well? What can I do better/improve?*'
- Arrange learners in groups of four (two pairs) at more or less the same level.
- Lower-level learners to practise a couple of times, then set up the role play. Encourage them to act it without reading the dialogue or worrying about mistakes. The idea is to develop fluency.
- One pair performs the role play, with the most confident member of the group taking the role of the interviewee. The other pair observes and provides feedback. Ask them to say one thing the interviewee did well and one he or she could do better.
- The next pair then acts out the interview and gets feedback. They then swap roles and perform again till everyone has had a chance to be the interviewee.
- Monitor and support noting any issues to address on a later occasion.

Differentiation

- Higher level learners should adapt the model dialogue and practise being interviewed for other jobs mentioned in the lesson, or a job they want, using the phrases and structures they have been practising.

If you have a group of higher level learners you could also use

<http://esol.britishcouncil.org/content/teachers/lessons-and-activities/lesson-plans/job-interview>

Answers**Resource 2**

1. b, c 2. g 3. a 4.e 5.f 6. d

Resource 3a

1. a. f; b. t; c.f; d. f;

2. It was hard. b) Lee did Maths, English and a cleaning course. c) Lee did Maths, English and a cleaning course

3 1 b 2a 3c

Resource 3b

1 .a) F b) T c) F d) F e) T f) F

2. a It was hard.; b Maths, English and a cleaning certificate. c Lee is happy to start work, it is a new start.

3. 1e; 2c; 3b; 4a; 5d

Resource 3c

1. a T; b ?; c F; d ?; e F; f T; g?; h T; i F

2. a It was hard.; b Maths, English and a cleaning certificate. c Lee is happy to start work, it is a new start.

3. 1 experience; more ; 2 do; 3 were; 4 drive; 5 did

4. 1e; 2b; 3c; 4a; 5d; 6e

Resource 5a

1 a can; b have; c drive; d do; e telephone; f are; g yourself; h polite; i can

2. Are you always on time?- yes I am/no I'm not

Can you drive? Yes I can/ no I can't

Do you have any qualifications? Yes I do/ no I don't

Resource 5b

2a Can you; b have...driving; c drive; e telephone; f are; g by yourself; h polite; i can

3. Past simple

4. I was; you were; I did; I learned; I had; I went; I used; I made

5a When; b did; c were

Resource 5c E 3 / N4

2. Past simple

I had; I went; I did; I learned; I made; I did

3

- a) Have you ever used a computer?
- b) Have you ever done any training?
- c) Has your employer given you a reference?
- d) Have you ever worked with chemicals?
- e) I have used a computer...
- f) I have done a lot of training....
- g) My tutor on the course has given me a good reference.

Transcript- - A job interview

Interviewer: Thank you for coming for your interview, today, Lee.

So, you want to be a cleaner. I see you've got some experience. Can you tell me more about that?

Lee: Yes, I cleaned offices and pubs after I left school. I got a certificate in cleaning last year.

Interviewer: That's good. Where did you get your certificate?

Lee: I got my certificate from Greenwood College, but I did the course in prison.

Interviewer: I see....how long were you in prison?

Lee: One year. It was very hard, but I used my time well. I studied English and maths and passed my exams, then I did the cleaning course.

Interviewer: And now....why do you want to work for us?

Lee: Because I really enjoy the work. On my course I learned how to clean different types of floor, like wood, tiles and carpet. I learned about different chemicals and polishes and about health and safety. I want to use what I've learned.

Interviewer: We work two shifts here. Is that a problem for you?

Lee: No, I don't mind.

Interviewer: Can you drive?

Lee: Yes, I've got a full licence.

Interviewer: Do you have a car?

Lee: Yes. I can use my partner's car.

Interviewer: We don't pay cleaners very much in the beginning but you'll get a pay rise after 6 weeks.

Lee: I'll be very happy with that. I think working here will give me a start in a new life.

Interviewer: Do you have any questions for us, Lee?

Lee: Yes....will I need to do any more training?

Resource 1 What is this picture about?



Resource 1 What is this picture about?



Resource 2 Before you listen: match the words to the pictures:

- a. chemicals b. floor c. cleaning machine d. carpet
e. polish f. driving licence g. certificate

1	2
3	4
5	6

Resource 3a Listen to a job interview (E1/N2)
1. Read the sentences below. Are they true or false?

Write T for true / F for false.

- a. Lee got a certificate in gardening.
- b. Lee likes cleaning.
- c. Lee was in prison for two years.
- d. The interviewer says the work is very hard.

2. Tick✓ the best answer to the questions.

- a) What does Lee say about prison?
It was hard.
It was interesting.
- b) What did Lee do in prison?
Lee did Maths, English and a cleaning course.
Lee worked as a wing cleaner.
- c) What does Lee think about the cleaning job?
Lee is happy to start work.
Lee wants to do training.

3. Read the interview questions and match them to the answers.

Listen again and check.

1. Why do you want to work for us?		a) Yes, I have a full licence.
2. Can you drive?		b) Because I love the work!
3. So, where did you do your certificate?		c) Greenwood College

Resource 3b (E2/N3) Listen to a job interview

1. Read the sentences about the interview below. Are they true or false?

Write T for true / F for false.

- a) Lee got a certificate in gardening. F
- b) Lee got a certificate in prison.
- c) Lee spent 6 months in prison.
- d) The interviewer says there are three shifts.
- e) The interviewer says the job isn't well paid.
- f) The interviewer says cleaners get a pay rise after six months.

2. Choose the best answer to the questions.

a) What does Lee say about the time in prison?

It was hard / it was interesting

b) What did Lee do there?

Maths, English and a cleaning certificate / Worked as a wing cleaner.

c) How does Lee feel about the low pay for the cleaning job?

Lee is happy to start work, it is a new start / Lee wants to do training.

3. Read the interview questions and match them to the answers. Listen again and check.

1. I see you've got some experience. Can you tell me more about that?		a) Yes, I have a full licence.
2. Why do you want to work for us?		b) One year.
3. How long were you in prison?		c) Because I love the work..
4. Can you drive?		d) I got my certificate from Greenwood College.
5. So, where did you do your certificate?		e) I cleaned offices and pubs before.

Resource 3c (E3/N4) Listen to a job interview

1. Read the sentences below. Are they true or false or not mentioned? Write T for true / F for false/ ? if it isn't in the interview.

- a) Lee got a cleaning certificate in prison. T
- b) Lee's course was full-time.
- c) Lee spent 6 months in prison.
- d) Lee liked the tutor on the Maths and English courses..
- e) Lee wants the job because it is from 9 am to 5 pm.
- f) The interviewer says the work they work two shifts.
- g) There are about 90 people working in the company.
- h) The interviewer says the job isn't well paid.
- i) The interviewer says there is training.

2. Listening for detail

- a) What does Lee say about being in prison?
- b) What did Lee do there?
- c) How does Lee feel about the low pay for the job?

3. Read the interview questions and complete them. Write one word in each space. Now match them to the answers. Listen again and check.

- 1. I see you've got some _____. Can you tell me _____about that?
- 2. Why _____you want to work for us?
- 3. How long _____you in prison?
- 4. Can you _____?
- 5. So, where _____you get your certificate?

- a) I've got a full licence
- b) Because I enjoy the work!
- c) One year.
- d) I got my certificate from Greenwood College
- e) I cleaned offices and pubs after I left school.

Looking for work outside unit 3 : interviews –classroom resources

Resource 4

✂ Cut up enough so every group of three or four learners has one set.

			
Can you...?	work in a team	work by yourself	drive
Are you ...?	polite and friendly	good on the telephone	smart
Do you have...?	computer skills	any qualifications	a full driving licence

Resource 5a (E1/N2) Preparing for interview

1. Complete the interview questions for each job: use the words in the box.

recycling operative

- a. **Can** you work in a team?
- b. Do you _____ a full driving licence?
- c. Can you _____?

administrative worker

- d. _____ you have any qualifications?
- e. Are you good on the _____?
- f. _____ you polite and friendly?

driver

- g. Can you work by _____?
- h. Are you _____ and friendly?
- i. _____ you drive?
- j.

telephone
are
have
can
drive
do
polite
can
yourself

2. Look at the questions and match them with the short answers.

Are you always on time?

Yes, I can. / No, I can't.

Can you drive?

Yes, I do. / No, I don't.

Do you have any qualifications?

Yes, I am. /No, I'm not.

Resource 5b (E2/N3)Preparing for interview
1.. Complete the interview questions for each job:
recycling operative

- a. _____ work in a team?
- b. Do you _____ a full _____ licence?
- c. Can you _____?

working in an office

- d. _____ have any qualifications?
- e. Are you good on the _____?
- f. _____ you polite and friendly?

driver

- g. Can you work _____?
- h. Are you _____ and friendly?
- i. _____ you drive?

2.. Read the sentences. Are the verbs in the present or past simple?

- a) I passed my driving test in 2005.
- b) I got my level 1 in maths and English certificate six months ago.
- c) I was in prison for one year.

3. Complete the table

Infinitive	Past simple
have/has	_____
be	was/were
go	_____
make	_____
do	did

Useful phrases

Where did you....?
 When did you...?
 How long were you...?
 Why did you.....?

I did mycertificate
 I worked as a
 I was a.....
 I really like.....because.....
 I'm always.....because....

4. Complete the questions.

- a) _____ did you get your licence? I passed my driving test in 2005.
- b) What qualifications _____ you do in prison? I did my level 1 in maths and English and my certificate in cleaning.
- c) How long _____ you in prison? I was in prison for one year.

Resource 5c (E3/N4) Preparing for interview
1. Questions about experience:

Have you ever worked
with customers?

Have you ever worked as a
driver?

Have you ever worked in a team?

2.. Complete the table

We often use the present perfect for talking about work or life experience.

Form: have/has [not] + past participle (+ ed to regular verbs)

Have you **passed** your driving test?

Yes, I **have**. I've **had** a driving licence since 2005.

No, I **haven't passed** yet.

Has he **finished** his training course yet?

Yes, **he has**.

No, **he hasn't**.

Irregular verbs		
Infinitive	Past simple	Past participle
have/has	_____	had
be	was/were	been
go	_____	gone/been
make	_____	made
do	_____	done

3. Complete the interview questions about experience below. Use the present perfect. Choose the correct verb in brackets.

- _____ you ever _____ a computer? [have/has][use/used]
- _____ you _____ any training? [have/has][done/did]
- _____ your employer _____ you a reference? [have/has][gave/given]
- _____ you ever _____ with chemicals?[have/has] [work/worked]
- I _____ a computer every day for the past ten years.
- I _____ a lot of training since I started my course.
- My tutor on the course _____ me a good reference.

Resource 6 interview dialogue

✂ Cut up enough so every pair has one set.

Hello. I'm Mr Ahmed. Welcome to ABC Cars.

Hello. Nice to meet you. I'm Pawel Kurek.

Why do you want to be a driver, Mr Kurek?

Because I like driving. And I have a lot of experience.

Do you have a clean licence?

Yes, I do. I'm a good driver.

Do you like working by yourself?

Yes, I never feel lonely. I listen to music when I drive.

Do you know the city well?

Yes, I know the city very well. I came here 10 years ago.

That's great! We'll let you know by tomorrow if we need you.

Thank you, Mr Ahmed.